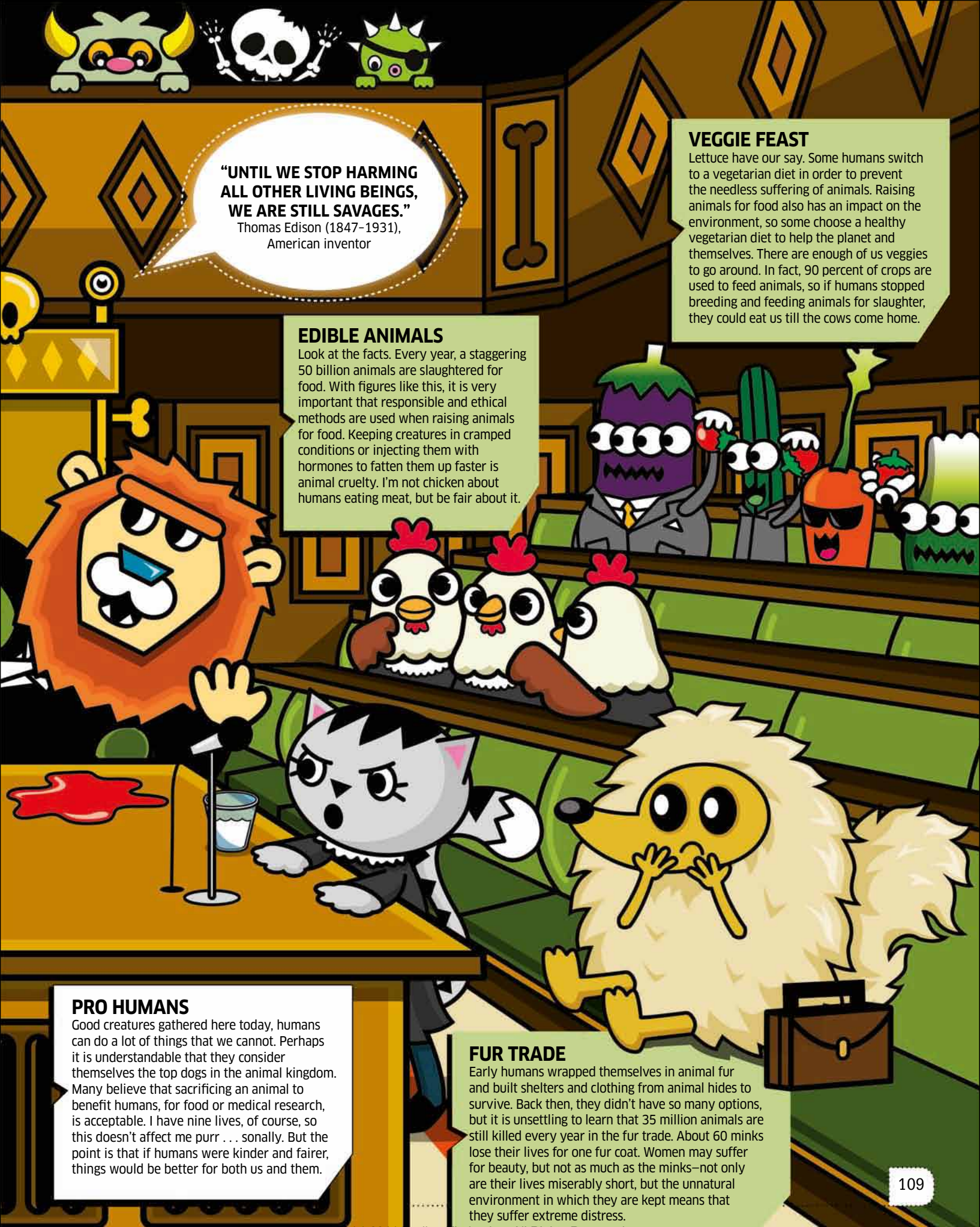




**"UNTIL WE STOP HARMING
ALL OTHER LIVING BEINGS,
WE ARE STILL SAVAGES."**

Thomas Edison (1847–1931),
American inventor

VEGGIE FEAST

Lettuce have our say. Some humans switch to a vegetarian diet in order to prevent the needless suffering of animals. Raising animals for food also has an impact on the environment, so some choose a healthy vegetarian diet to help the planet and themselves. There are enough of us veggies to go around. In fact, 90 percent of crops are used to feed animals, so if humans stopped breeding and feeding animals for slaughter, they could eat us till the cows come home.

EDIBLE ANIMALS

Look at the facts. Every year, a staggering 50 billion animals are slaughtered for food. With figures like this, it is very important that responsible and ethical methods are used when raising animals for food. Keeping creatures in cramped conditions or injecting them with hormones to fatten them up faster is animal cruelty. I'm not chicken about humans eating meat, but be fair about it.

PRO HUMANS

Good creatures gathered here today, humans can do a lot of things that we cannot. Perhaps it is understandable that they consider themselves the top dogs in the animal kingdom. Many believe that sacrificing an animal to benefit humans, for food or medical research, is acceptable. I have nine lives, of course, so this doesn't affect me purr . . . sonally. But the point is that if humans were kinder and fairer, things would be better for both us and them.

FUR TRADE

Early humans wrapped themselves in animal fur and built shelters and clothing from animal hides to survive. Back then, they didn't have so many options, but it is unsettling to learn that 35 million animals are still killed every year in the fur trade. About 60 minks lose their lives for one fur coat. Women may suffer for beauty, but not as much as the minks—not only are their lives miserably short, but the unnatural environment in which they are kept means that they suffer extreme distress.